

FOLLOW ME

Ver 2.0 — X-Plane 12 Plugin

Complete User Guide



A Follow Me car guides your aircraft to the assigned gate at Vancouver Intl (CYVR)

A FlyWithLua script for X-Plane 12 that spawns a real Follow Me car to guide your aircraft from gate to runway or from runway to gate — with SimBrief integration, animated vehicles, voice cues and a live navigation HUD.

Coussini • 2026 • X-Plane 12

1. Requirements

FollowMe Ver 2.0 is a **FlyWithLua** script for **X-Plane 12**. Before installing, make sure the following are in place:

- **X-Plane 12** (any recent build)
- **FlyWithLua NG** (latest version — must support floating ImGui windows)
- **Little Xpconnect** — required for the SimBrief HTTP fetching to work
- An internet connection if you want to use SimBrief flight-plan data

2. Installation

■ Before installing, delete any existing FollowMe files from the Scripts folder: remove all **.lua files beginning with FollowMe_** and delete the **follow_me/** folder entirely. Installing over an old version may cause conflicts.

Copy both items below into the FlyWithLua Scripts folder:

- **FollowMe_Ver2_0_Release.lua** — the main script file
- **follow_me/** — the companion resource folder (3D models, sounds, apt data)

The full installation path is:

...\\X-Plane 12\\Resources\\plugins\\FlyWithLua\\Scripts\\

 FollowMe_Ver2_0_Release.lua	2026-05-17 13:48	Fichier LUA	201 Ko
 follow_me	2026-05-17 13:49	Dossier de fichiers	

Both items must be present side-by-side in the Scripts folder

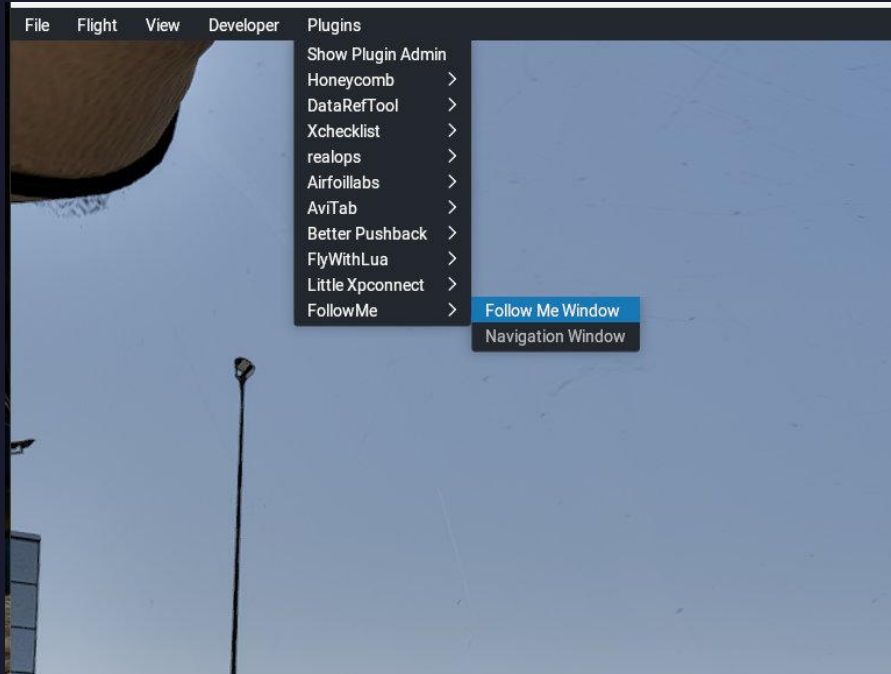
■ Do NOT rename the .lua file or the follow_me folder — the script looks for resources by exact name.

After copying the files, start (or restart) X-Plane 12. FlyWithLua will load the script automatically on the next simulator launch. No further configuration is required at this stage.

3. Accessing the Plugin

Once in a flight session at an airport, open the plugin via the X-Plane menu bar:

Plugins → FollowMe → Follow Me Window or Navigation Window



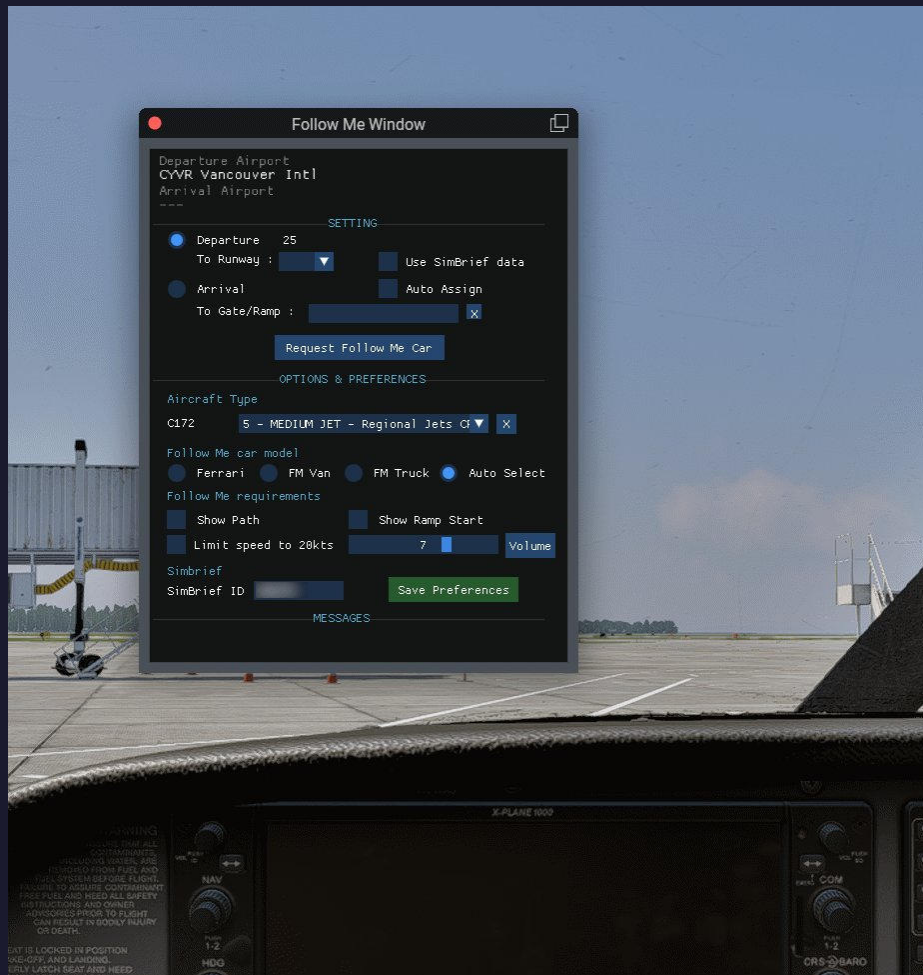
The FollowMe sub-menu exposes two windows: Follow Me Window and Navigation Window

■ Both windows can be opened simultaneously. Drag them anywhere on screen by clicking and holding their titlebar.

■ While the aircraft is airborne the FollowMe menu entries are greyed out and any open window will disappear automatically a few seconds after take-off.

4. The Follow Me Window

The Follow Me Window is the main control panel. It lets you request a Follow Me car for either a **Departure** (taxi to runway) or an **Arrival** (taxi to gate/ramp), set your aircraft type, choose the car model, and adjust optional display features.



Follow Me Window — default state at CYVR Vancouver Intl

4.1 Airport Information (top area)

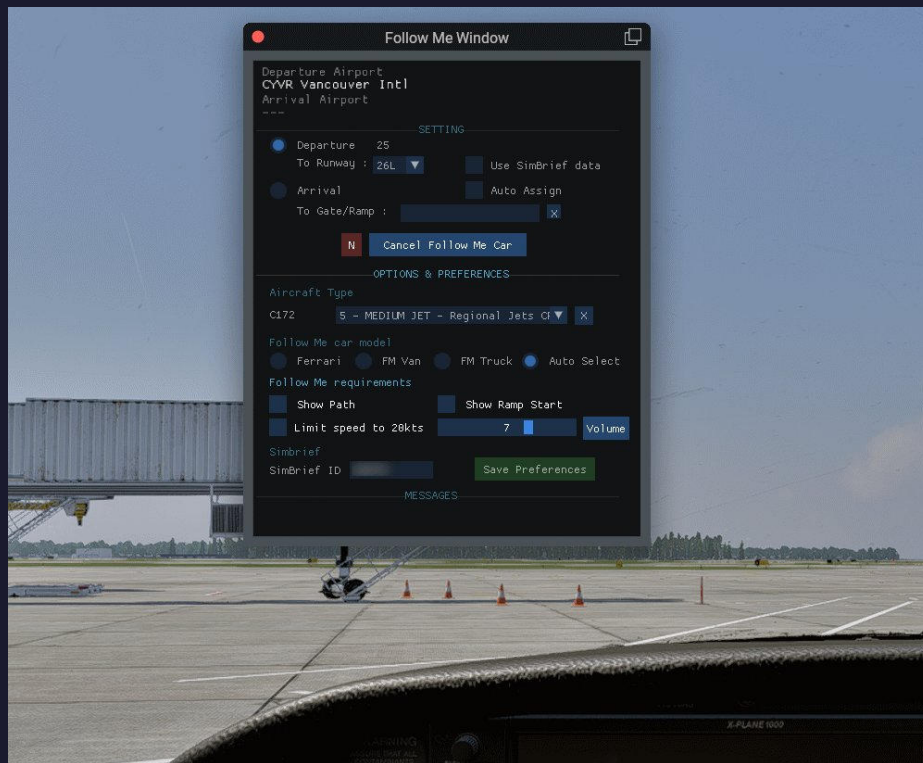
The top of the window always shows the **Departure Airport** and **Arrival Airport** detected from your current X-Plane session. When SimBrief data is loaded the airports come from your active flight plan instead.

4.2 Setting — Departure or Arrival

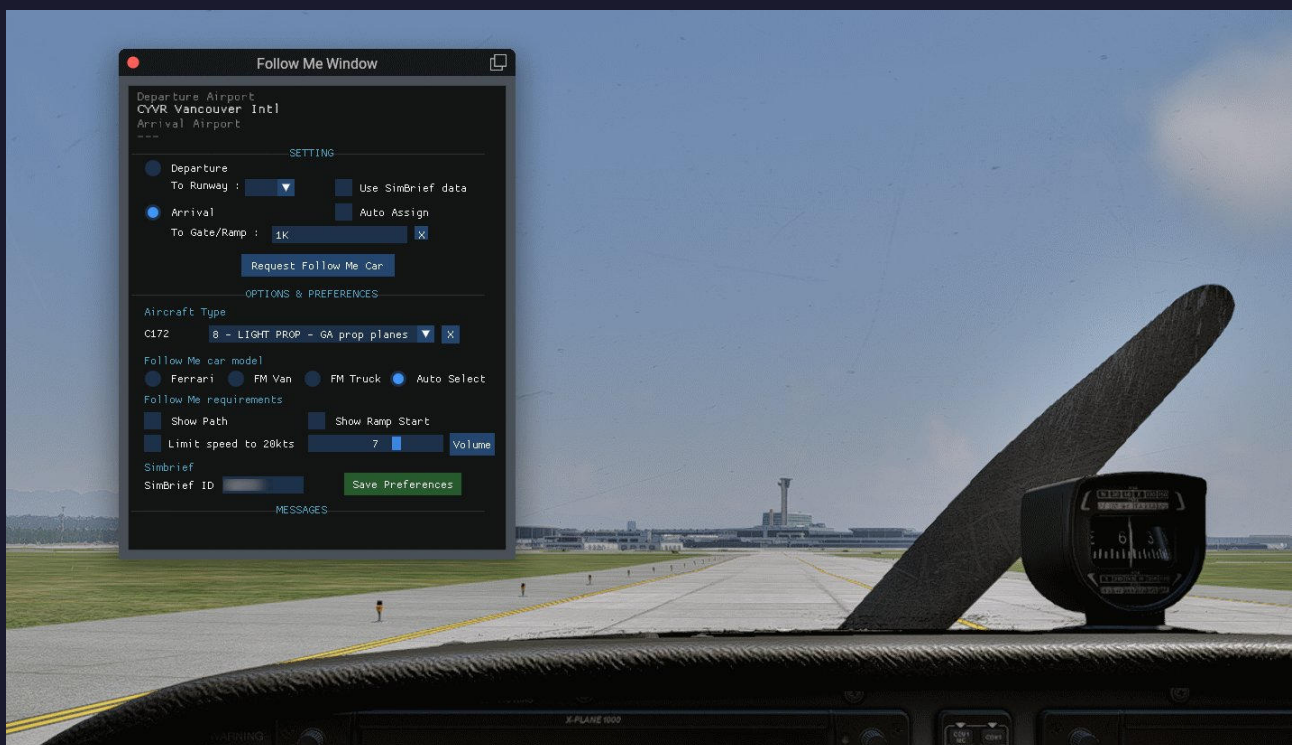
- **Departure** — Select this mode to request a taxi from your current position to a departure runway. Choose the runway from the dropdown next to *To Runway*.
- **Arrival** — Select this mode after landing to request a taxi from the runway to a specific gate or ramp. Type the gate name in the *To Gate/Ramp* field, or use **Auto Assign** to let the plugin pick one automatically based on your aircraft type.
- **Use SimBrief data** — When ticked, the **departure runway** is automatically pre-filled from your last SimBrief flight plan. Note: SimBrief data pre-fills the runway only — the arrival gate/ramp must still be entered manually or via Auto Assign. Your SimBrief ID must be saved first (see Section 4.5).

4.3 Request / Cancel Button

Press **Request Follow Me Car** to spawn the car and start the guidance session. The button turns into **Cancel Follow Me Car** once the car is active. Pressing Cancel removes the car and resets the session.



Follow Me Window — departure requested for runway 26L



Follow Me Window — arrival requested for gate 1K

4.4 Options & Preferences

These settings are saved between sessions when you click **Save Preferences**.

- **Aircraft Type** — Select your aircraft category (e.g., Light Prop, Medium Jet). The plugin remembers the last category used per ICAO aircraft code.
- **Auto Assign** — When ticked in Arrival mode, the plugin automatically selects an appropriate gate or ramp based on your aircraft type, without requiring manual input. This preference can be saved for future sessions via **Save Preferences**.
- **Follow Me car model** — Choose between a Ferrari sports car, an FM Van, an FM Truck, or *Auto Select* (the plugin picks a vehicle that fits the aircraft category).
- **Show Path** — Displays yellow 3-D balloon markers along the calculated route, making it easy to verify the path before you start following. Very useful for debugging unusual airports.
- **Show Ramp Start** — Places a marker at the ramp starting point.
- **Limit speed to 20 kts** — The Follow Me car will keep its taxi speed at or below 20 knots, giving you a comfortable pace to follow at large airports.
- **Volume slider** — Adjusts the loudness of the car driver's voice cues (e.g., *"Keep your speed at 20 knots"*).



"Limit speed to 20 kts" option — the car keeps a gentle pace in front of the aircraft



"Show Path" option — yellow balloon markers trace the entire taxi route for easy verification

4.5 SimBrief Integration

FollowMe can read your latest SimBrief flight plan to pre-fill the departure runway and arrival gate automatically.

- Enter your **SimBrief ID** (your Pilot ID, found in your SimBrief account) in the *SimBrief ID* field.
- Click **Save Preferences** — this stores the ID permanently so you don't have to re-enter it each session.
- Tick **Use SimBrief data** in the Settings section to activate the integration.
- The plugin fetches the *last saved* flight plan from your SimBrief account.



Messages section — a warning is shown when the current X-Plane airport doesn't match the SimBrief plan

■ If the current airport doesn't match the SimBrief plan, a red warning message is displayed in the Messages area at the bottom of the window. Clear the mismatch by loading the correct airport or unticking "Use SimBrief data".

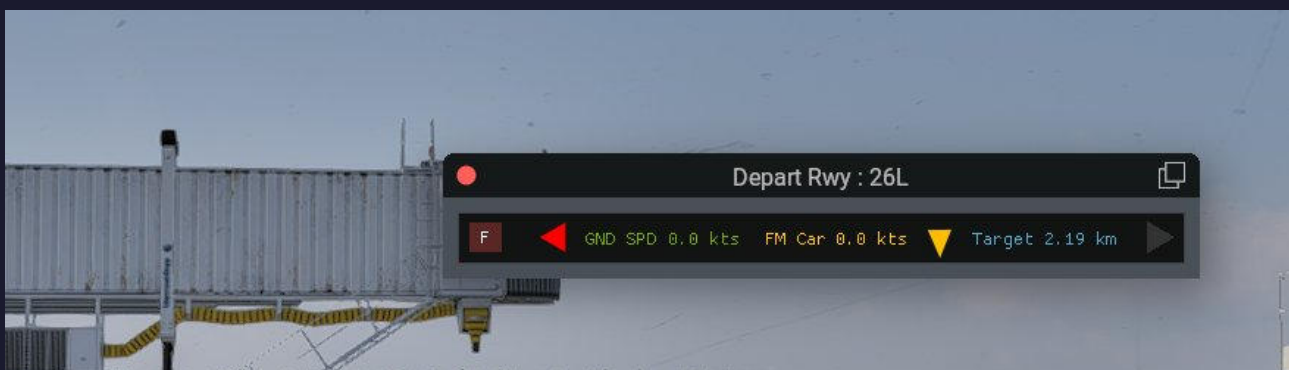
5. The Navigation Window (HUD)

The Navigation Window is a compact heads-up display (HUD) that appears once the Follow Me car is active. It shows real-time information about the guidance session:

- **Target label** — The gate or runway currently being targeted.
- **GND SPD** — Your aircraft's current ground speed in knots.
- **FM Car** — The Follow Me car's current speed in knots.
- **Target distance** — Remaining distance to the target in kilometres.
- **Turn indicators** — Animated coloured arrows show when the car (or you) should turn left or right.
- **Direction arrows (colour coded)** — **Yellow arrow**: indicates the current position and direction of the Follow Me car. **Blue arrow**: indicates the location of the target — either the departure runway or the arrival gate/terminal.
- **F / N buttons** — Switch between the Follow Me Window (**F**) and the Navigation Window (**N**) quickly.



Navigation Window — arrival guidance towards gate 1K, aircraft stationary



Navigation Window — departure guidance towards runway 26L

6. Quick Reference

Action	How
Open Follow Me Window	Plugins → FollowMe → Follow Me Window
Open Navigation Window	Plugins → FollowMe → Navigation Window
Request Follow Me Car	Follow Me Window → Request Follow Me Car
Cancel Follow Me Car	Follow Me Window → Cancel Follow Me Car
Switch to Navigation HUD	Click N button in Follow Me Window
Switch to Follow Me Window	Click F button in Navigation Window
Close a window	Click the round red button on the title bar
Re-open a closed window	Plugins → FollowMe → [window name]
Save SimBrief ID	Enter ID → Save Preferences
Adjust car driver volume	Volume slider in Follow Me Window
Preview taxi route	Tick Show Path before requesting the car
Limit car speed to 20 kts	Tick Limit speed to 20kts option
Auto-select gate (arrival)	Tick Auto Assign → Save Preferences
Change aircraft category	Aircraft Type dropdown → Save Preferences
Yellow arrow (HUD)	Current position & direction of the Follow Me car
Blue arrow (HUD)	Location of the target (runway or gate/terminal)

 **Have a safe flight !** 

FollowMe Ver 2.0 has been tested across numerous airports with a variety of runway and taxiway configurations. Enjoy realistic ground operations in X-Plane 12!

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7. Warnings

- FollowMe cannot generate routes that replicate the precision and complexity of real-world airport ground operations. Routes are computed from X-Plane's taxiway data and are intended as a simulation aid only.
- Some airports have no taxiways defined, or have taxiways that are poorly mapped in X-Plane's scenery files. In such cases the Follow Me car will not be available and an informational message will be displayed.
- Like a car GPS, the generated route may occasionally be incorrect or unexpected. If the Follow Me car appears to go off course or takes an unreasonable path, simply cancel the current session and request a new Follow Me car from your current position to generate a better route.
- The user cannot specify a particular taxi route to follow. Route planning is handled entirely by the Follow Me car based on the available taxiway data.